

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	P – Strategies to Empower People (STEP) Program
	Section No./Name	P-400-STEP Participation
	Document No./Name	P-410-STEP Participation Requirements
	Effective Date	January 1, 2021

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

The STEP Program mandates that, to the extent possible, all work-eligible families must actively engage in meaningful activities designed to enable their transition from receipt of FITAP cash assistance to self-sufficiency. Families must demonstrate active and diligent personal responsibility in achieving self-sufficiency through employment and increased workplace literacy or participation in other appropriate activities and development of the [Family Success Agreement](#) (FSA). ***

P-411-STEP - PO WORK-ELIGIBLES

A work-eligible family is a FITAP family (including cases which do not receive cash because their benefit would be less than \$10) which includes at least one adult under age 60 or a teen head of household, who is not disabled or incapacitated, or who is not caring for a family member who is disabled or incapacitated, as documented by a medical expert. Child-only cases are not considered work-eligible families but are included in the Federal Participation Rate in certain situations (see [C-120-FITAP](#)), section C-121-FITAP).

A work-eligible recipient is an adult under age 60 or a teen head of household who is included in a work-eligible family and who is not disabled or incapacitated, or who is not caring for a family member who is disabled or incapacitated, as documented by a medical expert.

Work-eligible recipients shall be expected to participate in work activities for the minimum number of hours specified by federal law or as required in the FSA ***. No work-eligible recipient shall be exempt from participation in such activities.

Work-eligible recipients shall be granted a temporary exception from participation in work activities until engaged by the STEP * Coach ** in the completion of a Family Assessment and Family Success Agreement.

When an assessment determines that a work-eligible recipient does not possess basic or workplace literacy skills, the recipient shall participate in a combination of employment and educational activities designed to increase basic or workplace literacy skills.

Work-eligible recipients who are pregnant or have a child under age 1 shall participate in Parenting Skills Training. If it is not the recipient's first pregnancy or first child, and the recipient has completed the current Parenting Skills Training, participation may be allowed in other work activities, if deemed appropriate by the worker.

Work-eligible minor parents who do not have a high school diploma or its equivalent shall attend school or related education classes designed to obtain a high school diploma or its equivalent. Participation in education shall be required in the FSA *** and shall be the primary work activity for these minor parents.

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P-412-STEP - PO GOOD CAUSE

Good Cause may be granted to a work-eligible recipient to temporarily excuse the recipient from participation in assigned work activities. Refer to [P-531-STEP-PR](#) Good Cause Reasons. Good Cause determinations shall not exceed six months per occurrence. Months in which a Good Cause determination is granted when a payee recipient is deemed temporarily incapacitated, ill, or disabled shall not count toward the recipient's 24-month time limit.

The FSA *** must be completed when a recipient is granted Good Cause due to incapacity or disability. It should include a plan for the recipient to return to or begin participation in appropriate work activities based on medical documentation of the duration of the incapacity.

P-413-STEP - PO UNIVERSAL ENGAGEMENT

The primary goal of the STEP Program is to ensure that all work-eligible families are actively and universally engaged in meaningful activities designed to enable their transition from receipt of FITAP cash assistance to self-sufficiency. To measure success toward meeting this goal, the * department has implemented a Placement Rate.

The Placement Rate is defined as the percentage of active FITAP families which include an adult in a given month that participate in some type of activity for at least one hour in that same month. Although some of these families may not be work-eligible, they are included in the placement rate calculations because of the manner in which the state performance indicator is calculated.

In an effort to assist all FITAP work-eligible recipients to achieve self-sufficiency, and to achieve the required state performance indicator, it is permissible to place recipients in both countable and non-countable activities. Refer to [P-420-STEP](#). All FITAP work-eligible recipients must be placed in some type of activity in order to achieve the required placement rate of 70%.

In addition to ensuring all work- eligible families are universally engaged in meaningful work activities, the following two categories of recipients should also be universally engaged in meaningful work activities:

- non work-eligible families
- non recipient parents living with a child receiving assistance

Note: Refer to [C-120-FITAP](#), section C-121-FITAP, for parents not included in the assistance unit but living with a child receiving assistance. Non-recipient parents who are an SSI recipient, SSI eligible with suspended payments, or do not meet the citizenship requirement may not be referred to participate in STEP activities or receive STEP Supportive Service payments. **

These families shall be engaged in activities designed to enable their transition to self-sufficiency. These activities can include but are not limited to:

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- keeping scheduled appointments with medical professionals
- applying for SSI
- participating in rehabilitation programs and any other activities that will enhance the transition to self-sufficiency
- any other work activity which will benefit the families

The FSA * must be used to record these activities and to allow for the entry of participation hours in LITE.

II. PROCEDURES

P-411-STEP – PR WORK-ELIGIBLES

Work-eligible families must be assigned the appropriate work registration code.

LITE will assign work registration codes for individuals based on recipient data, such as age, relationship, household affiliation, etc. Individual clients will be referred to participate in STEP based on the work registration codes explained in the following chart.

FITAP/KCSP Work Registration Description	Code	STEP Referral	Work-Eligible (State's Definition)	Counts for Federal Participation Rate Calculations	Counts for Placement Rate Calculation	Required Weekly Hours For All Families Rate
First Adult (Parent/Caretaker)	01	X	X	X	X	30
Second Adult (Legal or Non-legal spouse of First Adult)	02					
Temporary Incapacity	03	X		X	X	30
Age 60 or Older	04	X		X	X	30
Pregnant (No-Child)	05	X	X	X	X	30
Single Parent/Caretaker, Caring for child under 6 Not included in FITAP Grant	06	X	X	X	X	20
Victim of Domestic Violence	07	X	X	X	X	30
Teen Parent (Not Single) or Pregnant Teen (No Child), Head of Household	08	X	X	X	X	30
Single Parent/Caretaker, Caring for Child under 6 Included in FITAP Grant	09	X	X	X	X	20
Adult in Drug Rehabilitation	10	X	X	X	X	30
Permanent Incapacity	11	X		X	X	30
Reserved - Lack of Child Care	12	X	X	X	X	30
Single Teen Parent, Head of Household, Child under age 1, Not Meeting Federal Participation	20	X	X		X	
Minor Parent or Pregnant Minor, Not Head of Household (Dependent Child)	21	X			X	
Dependent Child age 16, 17, or 18	22	X			X	
Single Parent greater than 19, Child less than 1, Not Meeting Federal Participation	23	X	X		X	

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Incapacitated Single Parent, Head of Household, Child under age 1	24	X			X	
Parent Caring for a Disabled Family Member	25	X			X	
Dependent Child under age 19, Included in Grant	31					
Dependent Child under age 19, Dependent Care Costs Only, Not Included in Grant	32					

Work Registration Hierarchy and Assignment Logic

A client may qualify for multiple work registration codes. LITE will determine all codes that may be assigned to an individual and then assign the individual's work registration code based on the order found in the chart below.

Code	FITAP/KCSP Work Registration Description	Order of Hierarchy
03	Temporary Incapacity	1
11	Permanent Incapacity	5
25	Parent Caring for a Disabled Family Member	10
24	Incapacitated Single Parent, Head of Household, Child under age 1	15
04	Age 60 or Older	20
00	Conversion Value	24
20	Single Teen Parent, Head of Household, Child under age 1, Not Meeting Federal Participation	25
23	Single Parent greater than 19, Child less than 1, Not Meeting Federal Participation	30
06	Single Parent/Caretaker, Caring for child under 6 Not included in FITAP Grant	35
09	Single Parent/Caretaker, Caring for Child under 6 Included FITAP Grant	40
07	Victim of Domestic Violence	45
12	Reserved - Lack of Child Care	50
05	Pregnant (No-Child)	55
08	Teen Parent (Not Single) or Pregnant Teen (No Child), Head of Household	60
10	Adult in Drug Rehabilitation	65
01	First Adult (Parent/Caretaker)	70
02	Second Adult (Legal or Non-legal spouse of First Adult)	75
21	Minor Parent or Pregnant Minor, Not Head of Household (Dependent Child)	80
22	Dependent Child age 16, 17, or 18	85
31	Dependent Child under age 19, Included in Grant	90

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32	Dependent Child under age 19, Dependent Care Costs Only, Not Included in Grant	95
13	Reserved	100
80	Reserved - RCA Volunteer	105
81	Reserved - RCA Mandatory	110
82	Reserved - RCA Exempt	115

P-412 STEP – PR GOOD CAUSE

All Good Cause determinations shall be supported by documentary evidence and noted in **Person Notes.** **

P-413 STEP – PR UNIVERSAL ENGAGEMENT

Each Regional Administrator will determine regional and parish targets to insure that the designated placement rates are achieved.

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms and instructions associated with this policy.

IV. REFERENCES

Code of Federal Regulations, Title 45: [Parts 261, 262, 263, and 265](#)

[TANF Final Rule 2008](#)

[Act 58, 2003 Reg. Session.](#)